

Incident Report – Ticket #CS-0271

1) Incident Details

- **Type:** VPN – Login Attempt from Blacklisted Country
- **Timestamp:** 29-Jan-2025 11:20
- **Source IP:**
- **Destination IP:**
- **User:**
- **Hostname:**
- **Device Type:** macOS
- **Session Status:** Authentication Initiated
- **Message:** User Realm Corporate_VPN – Authentication initiated

2) Incident Summary

On **29-Jan-2025**, suspicious VPN login attempts were detected from a **blacklisted country (Hong Kong)**. The attempts targeted multiple employees (, , and).

Although the attackers had valid credentials, **all logins were blocked by Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA)** due to incorrect OTP entries. No successful VPN sessions were established.

3) Source IP Analysis –

- **Reputation:** Reported **94,075 times** on AbuseIPDB
- **Confidence of Abuse:** 0% (but high volume reports)
- **ISP:** Chang Way Technologies Co. Limited
- **Usage Type:** Data Center / Hosting Provider
- **Domain:** changway.hk
- **Country:** Hong Kong
- **City:** Central and Western

Observation: The IP belongs to a **data center in Hong Kong**, not consistent with the user's normal location (India).

4) User Details

- **User:**
- **Role:** DevOps Engineer
- **Primary Device:** (11-64)
- **Usual VPN IP:** (Spectra ISP, Delhi, India)

The attempted login originated from an **unusual country and IP address**, suggesting **credential compromise**.

5) VPN Log Analysis

Splunk query:

```
index=main source="vpn_logs.csv" "  
| table timestamp Hostname device_type authentication_method Message  
mfa_status session_status disconnect_reason
```

Findings:

- Multiple failed MFA challenges due to incorrect OTPs.
- The attacker **had valid usernames and passwords**, but was blocked at the MFA stage.
- No successful VPN sessions established.

6) IOC Scoping

IOC Search:

```
index=main source="vpn_logs.csv" (" " OR "185.7.214.37")
```

Findings:

- Same IP/hostname also attempted logins for:

-
-
- All attempts failed at the MFA stage.
- Confirms **credentials of three users were compromised**.

7) Email Gateway Analysis

Suspicious emails received from rebecca@princetonmercercer.org.

Splunk query:

```
index="main" source="Email_Gateway_logs.csv" "princetonmercercer.org"
```

Findings:

- **7 users** received a phishing email with subject: *"Distribution Remittance 84,300.09 Process_Ref..."*
- Malicious URL:

<https://princetonmercercerregionalchamberofcommerce.growthzoneapp.com/ap/r/99a0a6caa8a74d3b9e2e07ecc4ce9bf1>

8) Proxy Log Analysis

Splunk query:

```
index=main source="Proxy_logs.csv" "growthzoneapp.com"
| table Username "HTTP Method" "Response Code" "Web Category"
```

Findings:

- Three users (, ,) entered credentials on the phishing site.
- HTTP methods show **POST requests** → confirms credential submission.

9) Post-Login Activity Investigation

- No successful VPN logins were established.
- MFA effectively blocked all access attempts.
- No evidence of lateral movement, data access, or privilege escalation.

Conclusion: Credentials were compromised, but **attack was contained by MFA**.

10) Actions Taken

Firewall: Blocked attacker IP

IT Helpdesk: Reset credentials for affected users (, Lee, Chauhan). Terminated active VPN sessions.

Email Gateway: Blocked sender email rebecca@princetonmercer.org.

Proxy: Blocked domain growthzoneapp.com.

Awareness: Affected users were informed, reminded of phishing risks, and re-trained on MFA practices.

11) Conclusion

- **Classification:** True Positive
- **Impact:**
 - → Attempted login, MFA blocked
 - → Attempted login, MFA blocked
 - → Attempted login, MFA blocked
- **Security Impact:** No post-login activity, no resource access.
- **Ticket Status:** Closed

(Ruturaj Bhusari)